L-T-775B
June 26, 1975
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. L-T-00775A(GSA-FSS)
March 17, 1967 and
Fed. Spec. L-T-775
May 31, 1956

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

TRAYS, SERVICE, (ALUMINUM AND PLASTIC)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers rectangular aluminum and plastic service trays for use in the serving of food.

1.2 Classification. Serving trays shall be of the following types and sizes, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - Aluminum.

Size 3 - 20-1/2 inches by 15-1/4 inches (see table I).

Type II - Phenolic plastic.

Size 2 - 18-3/32 inches by 14-5/32 inches (see table II).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

QQ-A-250/GEN - (General Specification) Aluminum and Aluminum Alloy Plate and Sheet.
QQ-A-250/2 - Aluminum Alloy 3003, Plate and Sheet.
UU-P-553 - Paper, Wrapping, Tissue.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standard:

D 700 - Phenolic Molding Materials.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza., Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Type I trays (Aluminum). Aluminum shall conform to aluminum alloy 3003 of QQ-A-250/2 or alloy 3004 of standard commercial chemical composition.

3.1.2 Type II trays (Plastic). Phenolic molding compound shall conform to type 5 of ASTM D 700.

3.2 Type I trays (Aluminum).

3.2.1 Design and size. The design of the trays shall be in accordance with figure 1. The size of the tray shall be in accordance with the dimensions in table I.

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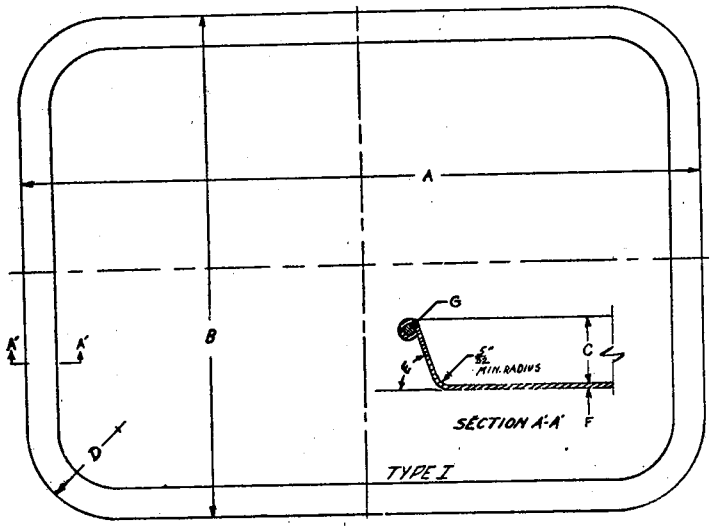


FIGURE 1.

TABLE I. Dimensions of type I aluminum trays

Size No.	A Length ± 3/64 inch	B Width ± 3/64 inch	C Depth inside ± 1/32 inch	D Corner radius ± 1/16 inch	E Side wall angle ± 1°	F Side wall and bottom thickness ±.005	G Bead wire ± .003
	Inches	Inches	Inch	Inches	degrees	Inch	Inch
3.....	20-1/2	15-1/4	1	2-3/4	73°	.050	.175

3.2.2 Construction. The trays shall be formed seamlessly from one piece of sheet aluminum not less than 0.050 inch thick, rectangular in shape, with flat bottom and sides tapered at a uniform angle to permit stacking. The edge of the tray shall be rolled over a tinned steel wire to form a tightly closed bead.

3.2.3 Flatness. The trays shall be flat within the tolerances permitted when tested as specified in 4.4.1.

3.2.4 Finish. The trays shall be finished in accordance with the manufacturer's standard commercial practice.

3.3 Type II trays (Plastic).

3.3.1 Design and size. The design of the trays shall be in accordance with figure 2. The size of the trays shall be in accordance with the dimensions in table II.

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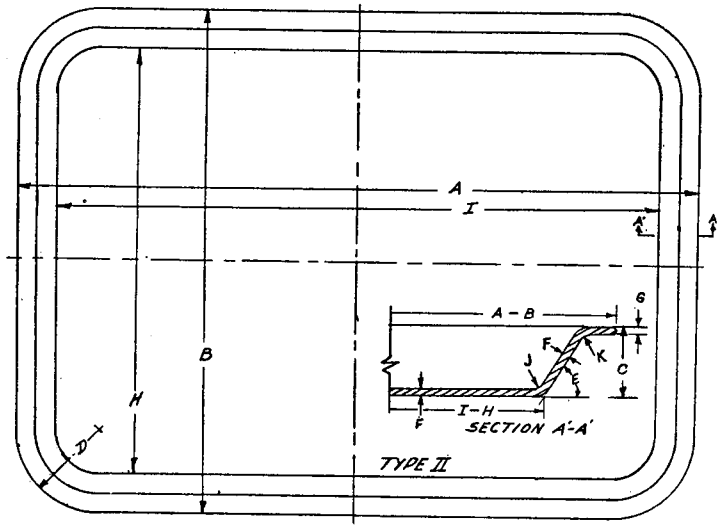


FIGURE 2.

TABLE II. Dimensions of type II plastic trays

Size No.	A Length ± 3/64 in.	B Width ± 3/64 (In.)	C Depth out-size ± 0.020 (In.)	D Corner radius (In.)	E Side wall angle (Deg.)	F Side wall and bottom thickness (In.)	G Lip thick-ness (In.)	H Width at base (In.)	I Length at base (In.)	J Radius of curve at base (In.)	K Radius of curve at lip (In.)
2....	13-3/32	14-5/32	.815	2-3/4 (± 1/4)	55-1/2° (± 1°)	.140 (± .020)	.150 (±.020)	12.8 (± 1/32)	16.71 (± 1/32)	5/16 (± 1/32)	3/32 (± 1/64)

3.3.2 Construction. The trays shall be rectangular in shape with flat bottom and sides tapered at a uniform angle to permit stacking and nesting.

3.3.3 Color. Trays shall be dark brown in color. Variations in color caused by distribution of filler shall not be considered cause for rejection.

3.3.4 Surface. The surfaces of the trays shall have a uniformly high luster throughout produced by molding techniques, by burnishing or otherwise treating the base material, and not by the application of a finish or protective coating of lacquer, varnish, etc. The finished trays shall be free of flash, imperfections, sharp edges or irregularities, blisters, dimples, and other defects which may affect their appearance and serviceability. After removal of mold flash, tray edge shall be burnished to a uniform finish compatible with other exposed surfaces.

3.3.5 Resistance to acids. The finish of the trays shall not show any change after being tested in accordance with 4.4.2.1.

3.3.6 Resistance to boiling water. The trays shall not warp more than 0.100 inch, and the surface shall show no signs of bloom, chalking, or other damage which may affect the appearance or serviceability of the trays after being tested in accordance with 4.4.2.2.

3.3.7 Resistance to alkaline solutions. The trays shall show no cracking or changes in surface appearance after being tested in accordance with 4.4.2.3.

3.3.8 Warpage. Warpage of the tray shall be measured as specified in 4.4.2.4.

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3.3.9 Water absorption. The trays shall not increase in weight by more than 1.75 percent of their conditioned weight, when tested in accordance with 4.4.2.5.

3.4 Workmanship. All service trays shall be free from defects which affect their appearance or which may impair their serviceability. All surfaces shall be smooth and free from rough or sharp edges.

3.5 Marking for identification. Trays shall be permanently and distinctly stamped or marked on the outside bottom surface (centrally located) with the manufacturer's name, trade name, or trademark of such known character as to be easily identifiable with the manufacturer. The marking shall be done in such a manner that the surface opposite the marking shall show no sign of surface penetration, surface roughness, or cause distortion of any part of the tray.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be made in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.2.1 Lot. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), a lot shall consist of all trays of the same type and size submitted for inspection at the same time. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated end item.

4.3 Inspection.

4.3.1 Visual examination. Trays shall be examined for defects listed in table III. The inspection level shall be II with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 2.5 for major defects and 6.5 for total defects, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

TABLE III. Classification of defects

Examine	Defects	Major	Minor
Finish:			
Type I tray	Not manufacturer's standard commercial finish.		X
	Stains, discoloration, wrinkles, or die marks.	X	
	Surface not smooth (rough or pitted), or not clean (oil, dirt, grease, or other foreign matter).		X
Type II tray	Color not dark brown, or wide variations in color (caused by other than distribution of filler).	X	
	Orange peel, not uniform high luster, or evidence of lacquer, varnish, or other coating material.	X	
	Presence of oil, grease, dust, wood shavings, metal chips, or other foreign matter on surface.		X
	Not uniform in texture, or lacks luster (dull).		X

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TABLE III. Classification of defects (con.)

Examine	Defects	Major	Minor
Construction and workmanship: (General)	Not specified type, design, or materal.	X	
	Deep cuts, nicks, sharp edges or corners, or blisters.	X	
	Waves, ripples, or other surface irregularities, affecting serviceability.	X	
	Slight dents, dimples, nicks, cuts, or scratches, affecting appearance.		X
	Surfaces and curves not blended smoothly.	X	
	Like units do not stack and nest firmly and evenly.	X	
Type I tray	Rolled edge uneven (distorted) 1/32 inch or more, or rolled bead not tightly closed (0.005 inch thickness gage will enter.).		X
	Not formed seamlessly in one piece.	X	
Type II tray	Broken, cracked, malformed, shrinkage, chipped, checked, deep pin hole, pit or flow mark.	X	
	Scuffed or abraded area; chalking or unfilled area.	X	
	Flash (not burnished).	X	
	Presence of metal particles, cured resin flash, dirt, etc., imbedded in material.	X	
	Corners not polished smooth.		X
	Objectionable odor, or characteristic phenol odor in material.	X	
	Insufficiently ground and burnished, (presence of flash burns or projecting ridges at dividing line of mold.).		X
	Poor nesting resulting in restricted air circulation (for drying purposes).	X	
Identification Marking:	Missing, illegible, incorrect, or incomplete.		X
	Evidence of penetration, uneveness or distortion caused from identification marks.		X

4.3.2 Dimensional examination. Trays shall be measured dimensionally for compliance with tables I or II, as applicable. Any nonconformance with specified requirements shall be classified a defect. The inspection level shall be II with an AQL of 6.5, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

4.3.3 Inspection of preparation for delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements in section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table IV. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

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TABLE IV. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defect
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Material	Any component missing, damaged or not conforming to the applicable specification or requirements stated herein.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as loose strapping, incomplete closure of container flaps, inadequate stapling or distortion of container.
Contents	Quantity per container is more or less than required. Gross weight exceeds the requirements of the box specification.

4.3.4 End item testing. Trays shall be tested in accordance with table V.

TABLE V. Test requirements

Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test procedure	Inspection level	AQL 1/
Flatness (type I only)	3.2.3	4.4.1	S-2	2.5
Resistance to acids	3.3.5	4.4.2.1	S-2	6.5
Resistance to boiling water	3.3.6	4.4.2.2	S-2	6.5
Resistance to alkali	3.3.7	4.4.2.3	S-2	6.5
Warpage	3.3.8	4.4.2.4	S-4	2.5
Water absorption	3.3.9	4.4.2.5	S-2	6.5

1/ Expressed in defects per hundred units.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Type I trays.

4.4.1.1 Flatness. Sample tray shall be placed face down on a flat surface. At no point around the four sides between the flat surface and the tray shall it be possible to insert a feeler gage exceeding 3/32 inch. Support one side of the tray approximately six inches above plane with the opposite side resting on the flat surface. At no point on the side resting on the flat surface shall it be possible to insert a 1/32 inch thick feeler gage. Each of the remaining sides shall be in turn supported in a like manner and checked for a variation of 1/32 inch or greater between the flat surface and the tray edge.

4.4.2 Type II trays.

4.4.2.1 Resistance to acids. One pool of 5 percent (by weight) acetic acid, one of 5 percent (by weight) citric acid, and one of 5 percent (by weight) tannic acid shall be made on the top surface of the tray. Each pool shall consist of approximately 15 drops of solution and shall be spaced sufficiently far apart to prevent mixing of the solutions. The solution shall be carefully deposited with a pipette or other instrument equally effective in preventing splashing and mixing of the pools. Four hours after the acid solutions have been placed on the surface, they shall be absorbed by means of blotting paper and the surface shall be wiped dry and examined for changes in the finish.

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4.4.2.2 Resistance to boiling water. Sample tray shall be placed bottom-up on a flat surface. A dial indicator shall be stabilized and positioned in such a manner that the pointer contacts the center of the bottom surface of the inserted tray. The indicator dial shall be adjusted to zero reading and then moved diagonally 9-1/4 inches from the center point to each corner. The height of each corner with respect to the zero position at the center of the tray shall be noted. The tray shall be then immersed in boiling water for one hour in a manner to avoid tray contact with the sides of the vessel containing the boiling water. After immersion, the tray shall be removed from the water, wiped dry, and allowed to cool to normal room temperature before examination. The height of each corner of the tray with respect to the center shall again be determined as above. Warpage shall be considered as the average difference in the height of the corners from the center point as measured before and after immersion. An examination of the tray surface shall be made for signs of bloom and damage.

4.4.2.3 Resistance to alkali. Sample tray shall be immersed in a boiling 2 percent sodium carbonate solution for 30 minutes. Tray shall be then rinsed in cold water, wiped dry, and examined.

4.4.2.4 Warpage. Warpage shall be determined by placing the tray in the normal use or serving position on a flat surface. The tray shall be firmly held in place by means of a 10-pound weight extending from rim to rim, positioned at the center of the tray, parallel to the short length. In this position, when measured by use of a feeler gage at each corner of the tray, each of the three corners shall make positive contact with the flat surface. The remaining corner shall not deviate more than 0.025 inch and shall not exceed 0.125 inch in warpage.

4.4.2.5 Water absorption. Sample tray shall be conditioned in an oven at 122° ± 4°F. (50° ± 2°C.) for 24 hours. After conditioning, the trays shall be allowed to cool to room temperature and weighed (W1). The trays shall then be completely immersed in distilled water and maintained at a temperature of 73.5° ± 2°F. (23° ± 1.1°C.). At the end of 24 hours immersion, each tray shall be removed, the surface water quickly absorbed by a dry cloth, and weighed (W2). The water absorption shall then be determined as follows:

$$\frac{(W2-W1)}{W1} \times 100 = \text{percent water absorption}$$

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Twelve trays shall be nested with paper conforming to UU-P-553, type I inserted between each tray the full size of the tray.

5.1.2 Level B. Trays shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1.

5.1.3 Level C. The tableware shall be packaged to insure protection during shipment and safe delivery to destination. The package and quality per package shall be the same as that normally used by the supplier for retail distribution.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Each stack of twelve trays of like description shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. The box shall be closed, reinforced and waterproofed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Each stack of twelve trays of like description shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with method I of the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The tableware packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed to comply with the National Motor Freight Classification rules or the Uniform Freight Classification rules.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, all marking shall be in accordance with 5.3.1 or 5.3.2 as specified (see 6.2).

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5.3.1 Civil agencies. Marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. Marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The trays are intended to be used as hand held carriers for dishes containing food in such establishments as cafeterias, mess halls, and hospitals.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type and size required (see 1.2).
(c) Size of lot, if different from 4.2.1.
(d) Levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(e) Marking required (see 5.3).

6.3 Deletions. Sizes 1 and 2 of type I, sizes 1 and 3 of type II of L-T-775; type II class designations and the class B tray of L-T-00775A(GSA-FSS) have been deleted.

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

GSA-FSS
VA-DMS

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